KHEELONA • POSITIONING PROPOSAL

Brain development, built through conversation

How Kheelu stands apart from “just another AI toy”

Nayantara · October 2026

THE RECOMMENDATION

Kheelu is the brain-development toy that talks.

It asks. They think.

Brain development is the promise. Conversation is the proof of how. Screen-free and safe are the foundation.

WHY THE “HOW” MATTERS

“Brain development” alone is not ownable

A crowded shelf

₹99 to ₹429 puzzles and activity books already sell as “brain development”. Kheelu needs a clear reason to cost ₹4,999.

A new fear about AI

Brookings (May 2026) warns of “cognitive stunting”: children letting AI do their thinking. Parents will ask about it.

Claims get checked

ASCI requires proof for claims and bars ads that play on parents' anxiety. “Brain” pseudoscience has made parents wary.

The answer to all three is the mechanism: **Kheelu asks, your child thinks.**

THE MARKET

Rivals sell friendship. Kheelu joins the brain-development shelf.

Top row: sold on brain development · Bottom row: sold as fun, answers or friendship · Left: child receives · Right: child does the thinking

Educational screens

Learning apps and videos. Sold as learning, but the child mostly taps and watches.

The brain-development shelf

Puzzles, activity books, STEM kits: build hands and focus, but can't talk.

Kheelu: the only one that builds thinking through conversation

Entertainment and answers

Cartoons on the phone, story players, smart speakers and chatbots. The child mostly receives.

AI companions

Miko (“a cherished companion”), MyWonder (“AI Companions”), Pookie (“friend-like companion”). They talk, but sell friendship.

THE EVIDENCE

Back-and-forth conversation builds young brains

Harvard Center on the Developing Child

“Serve and return” exchanges build and strengthen neural connections in a child's brain.

Romeo et al., 2018 · ages 4 to 6

The number of conversational turns, not words heard, predicted language scores and activity in Broca's area.

Xu et al., 2022 · Child Development

Children understood stories better and learnt more words when an AI asked them questions.

Honest limit: these studies are about conversation, mostly with adults. We say Kheelu is *built around* this idea, not that Kheelu is proven. Our own pilot data comes next.

THE KHEELU MODEL

Four thinking skills parents can see

Words

Kheelu uses a new word, then asks your child to use it too.

Report: new words used

Reasons

Kheelu asks “why do you think that happened?”

Report: why-answers given

Stories

Kheelu tells half a story and asks “what happens next?”

Report: stories told

Questions

Kheelu answers, then asks “what else do you wonder?”

Report: questions asked

Kheelu regularly hands the conversation back to family: “*Tell Amma what we found out.*”

WHO IT'S FOR

Parents of 4 to 7 year olds in Bengaluru

Mostly mothers, 28 to 40, English plus a home language, who already buy books, puzzles or classes for their child's development.

Not for now: under 3s, children 8 and over, or families seeking help with a diagnosed speech or developmental condition.

1 • Grow my child's mind in the years that matter

“I want to do something real, without pushing a 5-year-old into classes.”

2 • Make my child think, not just watch

Preschoolers ask about 76 questions an hour. Kheelu turns them into more thinking.

3 • The 20-minute swap

“While I cook or take a call, something good for their brain instead of the phone.”

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For Indian parents of 4 to 7 year olds who want to support their child's growing brain without more screens, **Kheelu is the brain-development toy that talks**: a soft, screen-free AI rabbit that builds four thinking skills through everyday conversation, in English and the family's own language.

Unlike puzzles, it talks and grows with your child. Unlike AI that hands children answers, it asks back, so your child does the thinking. And parents see the growth every week.

BRAND PILLARS

Three reasons to choose, one reason to trust

It asks. They think. Brain growth through conversation.

Makes them think

Asks back after answering, so your child reasons, not just listens.

Proof: pilot question counts

Builds four thinking skills

Words, reasons, stories, questions, at your child's level and in your language.

Proof: age-by-age activities

You see the growth

A weekly report on the four skills, compared only with your child's own past.

Proof: real app screens

Foundation: a toy, not a friend, that brings the family in

Screen-free · wake word · no browsing · read every chat · never asks for a secret · stories work offline

MESSAGING

One idea, said the same way everywhere

MASTER LINE

It asks. They think.

WEBSITE HERO

“Kheelu helps your child's brain grow, one conversation at a time.”

Sub-line: a screen-free AI toy that asks your child questions, so they think, talk and wonder more.

SUPPORTING LINES

“Other AI gives answers. Kheelu asks questions.”

“Puzzles build hands. Conversation builds thinking.”

“Give a gift that grows young minds.”

CLAIMS GUARDRAILS

A brain promise is only as strong as its weakest claim

Say

- “Built to support brain development through conversation”
- “NEP 2020: over 85% of brain development happens by age 6” (with source)
- “Kheelu is built around research on back-and-forth conversation”
- “Remembers what your child has learnt and loves”

Never say

- “Boosts IQ”, “makes your child smarter”
- “Don't miss the window”, “your child will fall behind”
- “Harvard-proven”, “as good as a parent”
- “Maps emotions and triggers”, “long-term memory”
- Speech delay, late talkers, therapy

WHAT CHANGES

How this builds on our research

Topic	Earlier thinking	Proposed
Core age	6 to 8 years	4 to 7; 3-year-olds only with a grown-up nearby
Framing	Tutor or teacher	Brain development through conversation
Differentiator	Safe and screen-free	Those are the foundation; thinking is the position
Price story	Cheaper than Miko	Compared with enrichment spend, not robots
Deck language	Maps emotions, life events, triggers	Learning progress only
Platform story	Kheelona OS, wearables, robots	For investors; parents see one product

THE 90-DAY PLAN

Same plan, sharper message

Test three versions by Gate 1

Mechanism, outcome and contrast lines, equal budget. Lowest cost per paid sale wins.

Show a child thinking

First 3 seconds of every ad: a child pausing, then answering “because…”.

Put the advisor up front

A named child-development expert in ads and on the site is the strongest proof.

Story Hours become Thinking Hours

Kheelu tells half a story; children say what happens next and why.

“Why question of the week”

A weekly Instagram series with an advisor tip, to build authority before ads scale.

One new weekly number

Questions Kheelu asked and answers children gave per session. It proves the promise.

FUTURE: LEARNING MODULES

How Kheelu earns a learning claim

STEP 1 · TODAY

Built on research

Activities follow published research on how young children learn.

Claim: “Built to support…”

STEP 2

Mapped to India's curriculum

Each activity tied to NCF Foundational Stage (2022) and NIPUN Bharat goals, signed off by the advisor.

Claim: “Aligned with NCF goals”

STEP 3

Measured with our families

A 2-minute spoken check every 4 weeks, like ASER's graded oral tasks.

Claim: “In our pilot, children…”

STEP 4

Tested independently

An outside partner runs a controlled study: Kheelu users vs a waitlist.

Claim: “Shown to improve…”

Every step up is a stronger claim. ASCI expects proof at whatever level we claim, so we only say what we've reached.

PHASE 1 • VOICE-FIRST, STRONGEST EVIDENCE

Four modules Kheelu can teach by voice alone

Numbers and maths talk

Child: counts things at home, compares more and less, solves story sums (“3 ladoos, Amma eats 1…”).

Evidence: math-story RCT, *Science* 2015: first-graders ~3 months ahead in maths. Number talk predicts number knowledge (Levine 2010).

Could claim: “Builds early number sense”

Sounds and pre-reading

Child: plays rhyme games, finds first sounds, breaks words into sounds and blends them back.

Evidence: National Early Literacy Panel: working with spoken sounds and remembering what was said strongly predict later reading.

Could claim: “Gets children ready to read”

Focus games

Child: plays opposite games (“touch your toes when I say head”) and freeze-and-go games with numbers in them.

Evidence: “Red Light, Purple Light” RCT, 2019, ages 3 to 5: bigger maths gains; self-control gains not yet significant.

Could claim: “Practises focus through play”

Stories and new words

Child: finishes and retells stories, answers “why” questions, uses new words.

Evidence: Xu et al. 2022: AI questions during stories improved children's understanding and vocabulary.

Could claim: “Builds vocabulary and story understanding”

PHASES 2 AND 3 • NEED MORE PRODUCT WORK

What parents will ask for next

Spoken English, with home-language help

Child: everyday English conversations at their level; Kheelu switches to the home language when they're stuck.

Needs: a level-by-level speaking curriculum and a way to measure speaking.

Could claim: “Builds confidence speaking English”

Science “why” explorations

Child: weekly topics (water, animals, the sky) led by their own questions.

Evidence and needs: AI dialogue helped children learn science from TV (Xu 2024). Needs an advisor-reviewed topic library.

Could claim: “Explores early science through questions”

Tables and mental maths (ages 6 to 7)

Child: quick voice games for tables, number bonds and doubling.

Needs: links to school-year goals up to Grade 3 (NIPUN Bharat). Easy to measure, so an early proof point.

Could claim: “Practise tables with Kheelu”

Letters and numerals, with cards

Child: finds letters and numbers on printed cards while Kheelu guides them.

Needs: a screen-free visual. Knowing letter names and shapes predicts reading, and voice alone can't teach shapes.

Could claim: “Learns letters and numbers”

NEXT STEPS

Six decisions this week

1 • Asking back

Does Kheelu end most turns with a question? If not, can it by launch?

2 • Skills report

Can the parent app show words, reasons, stories and questions?

3 • Advisor sign-off

Name the child-development advisor; approve “helps your child's brain grow”.

4 • Age range

Market to 4 to 7; 3-year-olds only with a grown-up nearby.

5 • Data answers

Where audio goes, how long it's kept, whether it trains AI.

6 • Claims check

Trademark “It asks. They think.” and review every brain claim before ads go live.